requires that both subjects and objects belong to a single field of experience. Since experience (contra the Buddhists) requires a stable subject, there must be a single transcendental conscious substrate of the field of experience. While he denies that the ***Nyaya*** realism's dichotomy between a physical world that is real in its own right and individual subjects of experience is the whole truth, he integrates their categories (***padartha***) within a theory of absolute idealism according to which the cosmos is manifested by a single, transcendental conscious dynamism. Categories such as individual substance, action, relation, generic property, natural kinds, quality, space, time and the cause–effect relation are objective realities, not human conceptual constructions (***kalpana***) as the Buddhists hold, because they are manifestations (*abhasa*) projected by the transcendental consciousness. Manifestations are types. Individual entities are composed of many such universals.

Through its innate powers of unfettered will, infinite knowledge and action, the Absolute creates all subjects, objects and occasions of experience in a causally structured framework of space and time. The dynamic and utterly independent *Shiva*-consciousness is modelled on our experience of consciousness ever oscillating between the illumination of objectivity (*prakasha*) and reflective awareness (*vimarsha*). This is influenced by the grammarian ***Bhartrihari***'s principle there can be no awareness without linguistic expression. *Utpaladeva* emphasises the liberty of individual subjective awareness, inspired by the compelling visions produced in meditation. Limited subjectivity is blamed on a principle called ***mala***, which his dualist ***Shaiva Siddhantin*** religious competitors think is a substance in its own right. For him, it is just ignorance in these sense of a narrow-minded type of awareness.

Further reading: Torella 2002